



MIDI Bridge - dLive

Quick reference — controls & first-run setup

A menu bar app keeping a permanent two-way link between your DAW and the dLive: it creates the “dLive Bridge” virtual MIDI ports and shuttles everything to the console over the network (MIDI over TCP).

Menu bar disc

Click	Show / hide the control panel.
Right-click	Show MIDI Monitor, Reload MIDI Monitor, or Quit (Quit is also in the panel footer).
Disc colour	Grey outline = stopped · Red = no connection · Amber, breathing = connecting · Green = connected · Cyan flash = MIDI flowing · Amber ! = error (click the status tile to open the log).

First-run setup

Console IP / Port	The MixRack’s address. Port defaults to 51325 (dLive MIDI over TCP).
Base MIDI Channel	Must match Utility → Control → MIDI on the console.
Your DAW	Restart your DAW after the bridge’s first start so “dLive Bridge” appears in its MIDI output list.

Options

Auto-reconnect	On: after a drop the bridge retries hard for 30 s, then every 30 s. Off: it stays red until you click Restart Bridge.
Verbose logging	Writes every MIDI message with raw bytes to the log. Debugging only — the log grows quickly.
Start at login	Launches the bridge with the Mac (default on).
Option key (held)	Reveals “Edit config file...” for advanced settings.

MIDI monitor

Panel peek	The last 5 MIDI events, live, under MIDI ACTIVITY.
Show MIDI Monitor...	The full stream: filter by direction, type or source, search, pause, click a row for raw bytes. Open it from the panel, or by right-clicking the menu bar disc.
Finding the window again	While the monitor is open the app appears in the Dock and in Cmd-Tab, and the window is listed in the Window menu. It follows you to whichever desktop Space you are on, and keeps its log when you reopen it.
Source labels	Every row is tagged with where it came from — your DAW, the console’s surface, the bridge’s own housekeeping, or a connected app by name (e.g. “Pilot Tone Trigger”). Use the source menu to watch one at a time.
Actions	Outgoing Control Changes on the base channel are shown as probable console Actions. Which Action a CC triggers is bound on the console, so the bridge flags the intent, not the name.
Simple / Advanced view	The monitor hides low-level protocol scaffolding by default; switch to Advanced to see everything on the wire — fader pings, heartbeat probes, NRPN address messages — for deep debugging.
The two dots	“bridge” = link to the bridge app; “console” = the bridge’s link to the desk — only the second means you reach the console.



Sharing the console

One link, many apps	Other software can reach the desk through the bridge instead of opening its own connection to the console. Talk Light Trigger, Pilot Tone Trigger and Console Control do this automatically when pointed at the “dLive Bridge” port, and Bitfocus Companion can connect to the bridge too.
Why it helps	One link to the console instead of several, and each app’s traffic is labelled by name in the monitor, so you can see exactly what sent what.
dLive Bridge Return	Console activity is passed back to your DAW on this second port. The bridge’s own background housekeeping is not, so it no longer clutters what your DAW receives.

Running it

Start / Stop / Restart	Controls the bridge process. After changing a connection setting, click Restart Bridge to apply it.
Status tile	Mirrors the menu bar disc, plus host, last activity and msg/s.

Important — if the bridge sits at “Connecting...” while the desk is reachable, another controller may be holding the console’s MIDI-over-TCP port. Quit the A&H MIDI Driver (or other control software) and click Restart Bridge.

Bitfocus Companion

Loopback only, port 8770, nothing to set up on this side — add MIDI Bridge in the dylanmaudio Companion module.

What it controls	Start, stop and restart the bridge, and Auto-reconnect — as Companion buttons, with the menu bar disc’s state, MIDI activity, message rate and any error shown back on them. Every dLive function (faders, mutes, scenes...) still goes through the bridge’s console connection, as under “Sharing the console”.
Allow Companion control	On by default. Off refuses every Companion press; Companion can still show why.
Lock show-critical controls	Off by default. On refuses stopping and restarting the bridge from Companion — starting it and Auto-reconnect are never locked.
Auto-reconnect	A change from Companion is saved at once and applies the next time the bridge starts, exactly like the checkbox in the panel.



Log files

Where they live	All in <code>~/Library/Logs/dylanmaudio/MIDI Bridge - dLive/</code> , one folder per dylanmaudio app — right-click the menu bar icon and choose Open Log Folder . Or skip the folder: Export log in the panel footer saves a diagnostics zip to your Desktop (this session's log, the previous one, and your settings) and shows it in Finder.
Session log	One file per launch, named by the time you opened the app. What the bridge is doing — connections, reconnects, each app that connects to it, errors — plus your settings at launch and every change. This is the one "Open Log" shows you, and the one to send if something goes wrong. The newest 20 are kept.
dlive-midi.jsonl	Every MIDI message, one line each, for detailed diagnosis. Off by default — turn on midi_log in the config file (hold Option in the panel to reveal "Edit config file..."). It grows quickly.
Managing it	The MIDI Monitor's footer shows its size, with Save a copy and Clear log file beside it — no need to go looking for the file. A saved copy lands in the same folder, stamped with the date and time.
Rotation	The MIDI log renames itself to .jsonl.1 at 100 MB and starts fresh, and any previous .jsonl.1 is discarded at that point. Save a copy first if you need to keep a capture.

What's new in v1.3.0

- Fixed: "Connected" now means the console is answering. Before, the bridge showed Connected as soon as anything accepted a network connection on the console's port, and could stay Connected, with "last activity" counting up, after the console had stopped responding. It now checks with the console straight away and every few seconds, shows "Waiting for a reply from ..." until the console answers, and notices within about 20 seconds when it stops, then reconnects.
- Fixed on macOS 11 and 12: the first click after opening the panel did nothing — it only brought the app forward — and a right-click showed a bare "Reload" menu; the app now comes forward as the panel opens, so the first click works. The window also shows all its colours there: the blue accents were missing, because those Macs' web engine didn't understand how they were written. Nothing changes on macOS 13 or later.
- One log, one folder. The bridge's own lines — connecting, connected, reconnects, each app that joins and leaves, errors — now go into the session log alongside the panel's, so "Open Log" shows everything in one dated file and Export log includes it (before, the bridge wrote a separate file that the export left out). Everything lives in `~/Library/Logs/dylanmaudio/MIDI Bridge - dLive/`, one right-click away as "Open Log Folder" on the menu bar icon. The MIDI monitor log stays its own file, saved from the Monitor page as before.
- Export log now saves a diagnostics zip to your Desktop and shows it in Finder — this session's log, the previous session's, and your settings — so one attachment covers a bug report. The session log itself now records your settings and where the app is running from at launch (a copy still running from the DMG is called out, since settings don't stick there), each setting you change, the bridge starting and stopping with its exit code, whether Start at login took, any error the panel shows, and a final line when you quit.
- Fixed: the MIDI Monitor no longer shows EQ, HPF and channel-assign changes as "fader moved". Parametric EQ, HPF, main, DCA and mute-group assignments, aux / FX / matrix sends, preamp gain, pad and 48V, and name and colour changes now each read as what they are — "Input 3 HPF → ~85 Hz", "Input 1 → Mono Aux 1 send → LV=107 (~0.0 dB)" — instead of appearing as a fader move or as an unlabelled SysEx line hidden under Advanced. They have a Params filter of their own.
- MIDI Monitor: you can now select and copy a message's raw MIDI without the row closing on you. Open a row and press Copy, or Cmd-click (or Ctrl-click) any row to copy its raw MIDI straight away; a fader, EQ or other NRPN change copies all three of its messages. The velocity-0 "note-off terminator" that follows every mute is now shown only under Advanced, so each mute is one row.